Japan hazard case knowledge organiser

Tuesday 9 March 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | LAUNCH | Spring 2 Week 3 | HUM-LAUNCH-S2-W03

White paper version. Read quietly, point, write, type, speak privately or direct a scribe who reads your words back. You may pass. No public answer or reading aloud is required.

Learning outcome: Explain effects & management of a hazard.

Keep the same case: Tohoku region Japan, 11 March 2011. The earthquake record used in this pack is magnitude 9.1 and depth 29 km. Explain a process before giving an effect label.

Idea	Meaning and case link
Primary effect	A direct effect of ground movement or shaking, such as building damage.
Secondary effect	An effect from a resulting event, such as tsunami flooding after sea floor movement.
Protection	Physical measures, such as retrofits or coastal barriers, that reduce some risks.
Preparation	Readiness through plans, practised routes, education and supplies.
Early warning	Sensors detect an event already under way. Warning time can be very short.

Effects overlap

Road, rail, power and water damage can involve more than one process. A damaged route affects both places and people. Explain what the card states before sorting it.

Warnings have limits

The first tsunami warning was at 05:49 UTC, about three minutes after the earthquake. Initial estimates were too low and were updated. Exact earthquake time, place and magnitude cannot be reliably predicted.

A combined approach

Protection, preparation and useful warnings can work together. A barrier can be overtopped and warnings need a prepared response. None guarantees safety.

Where this leads: Hazard planners and civil engineers explain effects, test protection limits and prepare clear plans for communities.